

■ The Farmer's Friend

With the rise of industry, agriculture has taken a back seat as farming became unprofitable due to various factors. To reverse this trend, the government waived Rs.7000 crore of co-operative loans. This has benefitted 22 lakh and 40 thousand farmers. Interest on co-operative agriculture loans was also reduced from 9% to 7% in 2006-07. It was again reduced from 7% to 5% in 2007-08. This year, it was reduced to 4%. One lakh 61 thousand poor farmers were given one lakh and 33 thousand acres of developed land. Under the Farmer- Agricultural social protection scheme, Rs. 160 crore assistance was given to 2 lakh and 84 thousand farm families.

■ Generating Employment

One of the most important steps undertaken by this government was to lift the ban on recruitment. So far, 2 lakh 81 thousand persons have been newly appointed in various government departments. The government signed MOUs for starting 19 new industries at a cost of Rs 25 thousand and 683 crore in the last 24 months. Employment opportunities were created for 1 lakh 74 thousand people.

■ Nurturing Culture

Tamil language and culture have always been kalaingnar's pet passions. Tamil was made a compulsory subject in schools from 1st std to Xth std. The government also founded the central institute of classical Tamil at Chennai. Presidential Awards to Tamil Scholars were instituted in the names of renowned Tamil poets, Thiruvalluvar and Tholkappiar. An Act was passed in the Tamilnadu legislature, whereby the first day of the Tamil month "Thai" is to begin the Tamil New Year. Renovations were carried out and Kumbhabhishegam performed in 2239 temples at a cost of Rs. 37 crore.

■ Infrastructure Development

With Chennai becoming a hot destination on the IT map, developing infrastructure has been a special priority. 110 urban drinking water schemes were executed at a cost of Rs. 236 crore 58 lakh. This benefitted 23 lakh 88 thousand people. The Ramanathapuram Comprehensive Drinking water Scheme was implemented at a cost of Rs. 616 crore, while the Hogenakkal Comprehensive Drinking water supply scheme was implemented at a cost of Rs.1334 crore. Underground drainage system was

laid in 28 district head-quarters at a cost of Rs.1362 crore. Work has already been completed in Tiruchirapalli, Madurai, Tirunelveli, Thanjavur and Karur.

6500 new buses were provided. Another 3500 new buses will go on the road this year. Flyovers on arterial roads to ease traffic congestion and introduction of A/c luxury buses have also gone a long way to improve public transportation. One lakh and 6 thousand concrete houses and flats were constructed at a cost Rs. 2787 crore under Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Development Scheme. Works worth Rs. 603 crore were successfully completed under National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme. 82% women and 59% Adi Dravidars were benefitted.

■ Minority Oriented Measures

Kalaingnar has always been sensitive to the needs of minorities. This time, the government took the initiative to establish a separate Directorate for the welfare of minorities. The government also accorded statutory status to women's Commission and Minorities' Commission of Tamilnadu. 3.5% reservation for Christians and Muslims was introduced.

■ Others

Among other measures, free electricity was provided to handloom and powerloom weavers. Assistance to the tune of Rs. 239 crore was disbursed to 5 lakh 82 thousand labourer families in the unorganized sector through 24 unorganized Labour Welfare Boards. Rs. 908 crore bank loan was given to 95 thousand 302 new Self Help Groups and 50 thousand 83 new Self Help Groups formed to benefit 10 lakh women. 19 thousand 698 Self Help Groups were formed for youth and various industrial training was provided to 11 thousand 485 youth. 3 lakh 39 thousand 966 unemployed youth were given monthly assistance of Rs. 116 crore and 53 lakh. The government also abolished the entrance exam for professional courses.

■ Committed to Deliver

This government came to power on the strength of many promises that it had made to the people of Tamilnadu. One by one, their promises have been fulfilled. With three more years left for the next election, we are confident by that time the state goes to polls again, not one promise will remain unfulfilled. Rest assured that our performance will speak louder than our words.



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